

List of Kanji

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漢字 3: Form (形)

形	形	Notes:
Form. Shape. Appearance.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	一 + 升 + 彡
English	One + Two hands + Hair/Feather/Bristle

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Form	⌈a⌋ ⌈two-handed⌋ ⌈feather⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ケイ (KEI)	かたち、かた (katachi, kata)

かたち is the choice when this 漢字 appears on its own; in such a case it means “form” or “shape”. In compounds, look for ケイ in the first position (with a notable exception being the second example below), and a split between ケイ and かた after that, keeping in mind that かた is almost always voiced in such instances.

L.C.	ギョウ (GYŌ)	—
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This is a very uncommon reading that you are only likely to meet in the word for “doll”, 人形 (NINGYŌ/ニンギョウ) from the 漢字 for ‘person’ and ‘form’.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The form <catalogue> is ⟨GYONE⟩ with <car-touching> ⟨CATERING⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
形	form; shape	かたち (katachi)
形見	form + see = memento; keepsake	かたみ (katami)
手形	hand + form = bill; draft; note	てがた (tegata)
形成	form + become = formation	ケイセイ (KEISEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

林檎	の	形	は	丸い。
リンゴ	の	かたち	は	まるい
apple	の	form	は	round
An apple is round in shape.				

漢字 4: Target (的)

的	的	Notes:
Target.		

This is an important character that is used as a suffix to express such ideas as the English equivalent of “-istic” in word such as “artistic”.

If you spend some time getting to know this 漢字, you will quickly notice your vocabulary growing in sophistication.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	白 + 勺 + 丶
English	White + Embracing/Wrap + Dot

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Target	the [white] [wrapped] [dot].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	テキ (TEKI)	—
L.C.	—	まと (mato)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The target was the <ma-to-be> wearing ⟨TEKKIES⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry ?? that ‘literature’ plus ‘change’ in the second example below means “culture”, and from Entry ?? that ‘tool’ plus ‘body’ in the third example means “definite; concrete”.		
目的	eye + target = purpose; aim	モク・テキ (MOKU·TEKI)
文化的	culture + target = cultural	ブン・カ・テキ (BUNKA·TEKI)
具体的	definite + target = definite; specific; concrete	グタイ・テキ (GUTAI·TEKI)

{...} Sample Sentence

入国	目的	は	何	です	か。
ニュウコク	モクテキ	は	なに	です	か
entry to a country	purpose	は	what	be/is	か
What is the purpose of your visit?					

漢字 5: Arrow (矢)

 	Notes:
Arrow.	
As these are the same two components used to make the 漢字 for “Lose” (Entry ??, 失), ensure that you are able to tell them apart.	

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	矢
English	Arrow

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#111).

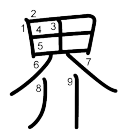
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	や (ya)
L.C.	シ (SHI)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Arrows	〈SHIELDED〉 away from the <young>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
矢	arrow	や (ya)
弓矢	bow + arrow = <i>bow and arrow</i>	ゆみ・や (yumiya)

{...} Sample Sentence				
矢	は	的	に	当たった。
や	は	てき	に	あたった
arrow	は	target	に	to be hit
<i>The arrow hit the target.</i>				

漢字 6: World (界)

 	Notes:
World.	
Circles (in the sense of “financial circles” or “scientific circles”, etc.).	

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	田 + 介
English	Rice Field + Intervene (??)

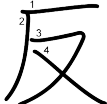
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
The world of [rice fields] needs an [intervention].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カイ (KAI)	—
L.C.	—	—

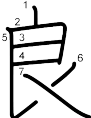
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
World	of ⟨KITE⟩ fanatics.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
世界	society + world = <i>the world</i>	セ・カイ (SEKAI)
魚介	business + world = <i>the business world</i>	ギョ・カイ (GYOKAI)
自然界	self + nature + world = <i>the world of nature</i>	シ・ゼン・カイ (SHI-ZEN-KAI)

{...} Sample Sentence				
世界	最長	な	の	です。
セカイ	サイチョウ	な	の	です
world	longest	な	の	be/is
<i>It is the longest in the world.</i>				

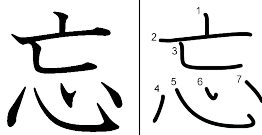
漢字 7: Against (反)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Against. Anti-.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	厂 + 又	
English	Cliff + Again	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Against	[cliffs] [again].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ハン (HAN)	—
L.C.	タン、ホン (TAN, HON)	そ (so)

♫♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Against	↳softies↳ which are (HAUNTED) by (TONS) of (HUNCHES).	
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
反転	against + roll = <i>roll over; reverse</i>	ハン・テン (HAN·TEN)
反動	against + move = <i>reaction; recoil</i>	ハン・ドウ (HAN·DŌ)
反対	against + versus = <i>opposition; resistance</i>	ハン・タイ (HAN·TAI)
{...} Sample Sentence		
右	と	左 は 反対語 です。
みぎ	と	ひだり は ハンタイゴ です
right	と	left は antonym be/is
Right and left are opposites.		

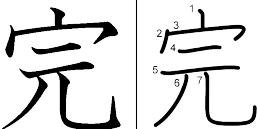
漢字 8: Good (良)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Good.		
∈ Composition		
Glyphs	良	
English	Boundary	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#138).		
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	リョウ (RYŌ)	よ (yo)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations				
A	good	<yomp> with <RYOBI> gear.		
+ Words and Compounds				
Kanji	English	Pronunciation		
良い	<i>good</i>	よい (yoi)		
良心	good + heart = <i>conscience</i>	リョウシン (RYŌSHIN)		
良好	good + like = <i>satisfactory</i>	リョウコウ (RYŌKŌ)		
{...} Sample Sentence				
良心	が	彼	を	苦しめた。
リョウシン	が	かれ	を	くるしめた
conscience	が	he	を	to torment
<i>His conscience stung him.</i>				

I do a lot of worrying.

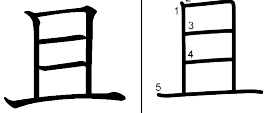
漢字 11: Forget (忘)		
	<u>Notes:</u>	
Forget.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亡 + 心	
English	Conceal/Dead + Heart	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Forget	your [concealed] [heart].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ボウ (BŌ)	わす (wasu)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations				
Forget	〈BORING〉 <wassups>.			
+ Words and Compounds				
Kanji	English	Pronunciation		
忘れる	<i>forget</i>	わすれる (wasureru)		
忘れ物	forget + thing = <i>something left behind</i>	わすれ もの (wasure mono)		
忘年会	forget + year + meet = <i>year-end party</i>	ボウ・ネン・カイ (BŌ-NEN-KAI)		
{···} Sample Sentence				
電車	に	傘	を	忘れた。
デンシャ	に	かさ	を	わすれた
train	に	umbrella	を	forget
<i>I left my umbrella on the train.</i>				

漢字 12: Perfect (完)		
	<u>Notes:</u>	
Perfect. Complete.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	宀 + 元	
English	Roof + Beginning/Former/Origin	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Perfect	[roof] for a perfect [beginning].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カン (KAN)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations			
Perfect	〈CUNNING〉.		
+ Words and Compounds			
Kanji	English	Pronunciation	
完全	perfect + complete = <i>perfection;</i> <i>completeness</i>	カンゼン (KANZEN)	
完成	perfect + become = <i>completion;</i> <i>accomplishment</i>	カンセイ (KANSEI)	
完結	perfect + bind = <i>completion; conclusion</i>	カンケツ (KAN-KETSU)	
{...} Sample Sentence			
完全	に	は	治りません。
カンゼン	に	は	なおりません
completeness	に	は	be at peace
It cannot be completely cured.			

漢字 13: Besides (且)

	Notes:
Besides. Moreover.	

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	目 + 一
English	Eye + One

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Besides the [one] [eye].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	か (ka)
L.C.	シヨ (SHO)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Moreover, you should let <customers> (SHOP).
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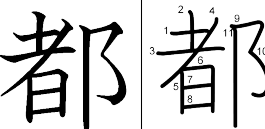
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
且つ	<i>besides</i>	かつ (katsu)

{...} Sample Sentence

彼	は	詩人	で	あり、	且つ	小説家	だ。
かれ	は	シジン	で	あり	かつ	ショウセツカ	だ
he	は	poet	で	あり	and	novelist	だ
<i>He is a poet and a novelist.</i>							

漢字 14: Metropolis (都)

	Notes:
Metropolis. Large City.	

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	者 + 邑
English	Individual + City

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
A metropolis is an [individual] [city] on its own.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ト (TO)	みやこ (miyako)
L.C.	ツ (TSU)	—

You will only meet this 音読み in two compounds: the first being 都合 (ツ・ゴウ/TSU-GŌ) “circumstances”/“arrangements”, composed of the 漢字 ‘metropolis’ and ‘match’.

The second compound is 都度 (ツ・ド/TSU-DO) “each time”/“whenever” from the 漢字 ‘metropolis’ and ‘degree’.

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The metropolis <Mia completed> was <TOPPLED> by a <TSUNAMI>.
--

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
都	<i>metropolis; capital</i>	みやこ (miyako)
京都	capital + metropolis = <i>Kyoto</i>	キョウト (KYŌ-TO)
首都	neck + metropolis = <i>capital city</i>	シュト (SHU-TO)

{...} Sample Sentence

大都市	は	嫌い	です。
ダイトシ	は	きらい	です
big cities	は	hate	be/is
<i>I hate big cities.</i>			

漢字 15: Descend (降)

降	降	Notes:
Descend. Fall. Surrender.		
This is the character used when describing the “falling” of rain or snow, etc.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	十 + 冫 + 阜 + 夂
English	Ten + Hill/Dam/Mound + Winter

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
The descending 「scarecrow」 was 「wintering」 in the 「mound」.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	ふ (fu)
L.C.	—	お (o)

This reading forms an intransitive/transitive verb pair (降りる/降ろす) that has the same pronunciation as one we met earlier with the 漢字 下 (Entry ??): 下りる/下ろす. The characters are sometimes used interchangeably, although you are more likely to see them written as 下りる and 下ろす.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Descending scores <CAUSED> the <foosball> team to feel an <obligation>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
降る	<i>falling (rain/snow)</i>	ふる (furu)
降下	descend + lower = <i>descent; landing</i>	コウ・カ (KŌ-KA)
降水	descend + water = <i>precipitation</i>	コウ・スイ (KŌ-SUI)

{...} Sample Sentence		
雨	が	降っている。
あめ	が	ふっている
rain	が	precipitate
<i>It is raining.</i>		

漢字 16: Marriage (婚)

婚	婚	Notes:
Marriage.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	日 + 女 + 氏
English	Sun + Woman/Female + Clan

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Marrying a 「woman」 into a 「clan」 on a certain 「day」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コン (KON)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Marriage <CON>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
離婚	separage + marriage = <i>divorce</i>	リ・コン (RIKON)
結婚	bind + marriage = <i>marriage</i>	ケツ・コン (KEK-KON)
婚期	marriage + period = <i>marriageable age</i>	コン・キ (KON-KI)

{...} Sample Sentence				
彼女	は	夫	と	離婚した。
かのジョ	は	おっと	と	リコンした
she	は	husband	と	divorce
<i>She divorced her husband.</i>				

漢字 17: Festival (祭)

祭	祭	Notes:
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Festival.

This 漢字 can also have some religious overtones in the senses of ritual and worship.

Note that the first stroke of ‘again’ is clipped off in some fonts so that it does not pass through the second.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	月 + 又 + 示
English	Moon + Again + Show

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Festivals during full [moon] are on [display].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	サイ (SAI)	まつ (matsu)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A festival of <PSYCHO> <mutts>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
祭り	<i>festival</i>	まつり (matsuri)
祭日	festival + sun (day) = <i>festival day</i>	サイ・ジツ (SAIJITSU)
百年祭	hundred + year + festival = <i>centennial</i>	ヒャク・ネン・サイ (HYAKU-NENSAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

祭り	が	終わった。
まつり	が	おわった
festial	が	end
The festival came to an end.		

漢字 18: Finger (指)

指	指	Notes:
---	---	--------

Finger, along with the senses of “indicating” and “pointing”.

Note that this 漢字 never appears as a component in other characters.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	手 + 扌 + 旨
English	Hand/Actions + Gist (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Fingers show the [gist] of your [hand].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シ (SHI)	ゆび、さ (yubi, sa)
As the second compound below shows, さ can become voiced outside of the first position.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

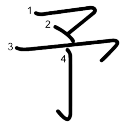
His finger indicated to a <summary> on the <SHIELD> which stated: “<you before> me”

+ Words and Compounds

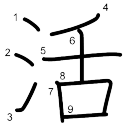
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
指	<i>finger</i>	ゆび (yubi)
目指す	eye + finger = <i>aim at</i>	め ざす (me zasu)
指名	finger + name = <i>nomination;</i> <i>designation</i>	シ・メイ (SHIMEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

足	の	小指	が	痛む。
あし	の	こゆび	が	いたむ
foot	の	little finger	が	to hurt
I have pain in my little toe.				

漢字 19: Beforehand (予)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Beforehand, previously.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亅 + 一 + マ	
English	Hook + One + MA katakana	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Beforehand	[mum] took [one] [hook].	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヨ (YO)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Previous <YOB>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
予言	beforehand + say = <i>prediction</i>	ヨ・ゲン (YO-GEN)
予定	beforehand + fixed = <i>prearrangement; plan</i>	ヨ・テイ (YO-TEI)
予期	beforehand + period = <i>anticipation; expectation</i>	ヨ・キ (YO-KI)

漢字 20: Active (活)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Active, Lively.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	舌 + 水 𠂔	
English	Tongue + Water	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Actively	the [tongue] was taking [water] in.	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カツ (KATSU)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Active , lively <CUTS>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
生活	life + active = <i>life; livelihood</i>	セイ・カツ (SEIKATSU)
活気	active + spirit = <i>liveliness; vigour</i>	カッ・キ (KAK-KI)
活動	active + move = <i>activity; action</i>	カツ・ドウ (KATSU-DŌ)

漢字 21: Harmony (和)

Notes:

Harmony, peace.

This 漢字 is also used as an abbreviation for Japan in much the same way 日 is (the final compound offers an example of this usage).

∈ Composition

Glyphs	口 + 禾
English	Mouth/Opening/Sounding + Grain (Ear)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Harmonious [sounding] of grinding [grain].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ワ (WA)	—
L.C.	オ (O)	やわ、なご (yawa, nago)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Harmonious <WASHING> of <Nago> <OBJECTS> with <ya water>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
和	<i>harmony</i>	ワ (WA)
平和	flat + harmony = <i>peace</i>	ヘイ・ワ (HEIWA)
和食	harmony (Japan) + eat = <i>Japanese food</i>	ワ・ショク (WASHOKU)

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
大和	large + harmony = <i>Ancient Japan</i>	やまと (yamato)
日和	sun + harmony = <i>fine weather</i>	ひより (hiyori)

漢字 22: Via (経)

Notes:

Via, in the sense of things passing or elapsing.

A secondary meaning related to Buddhist sutras make use of the less common on-yomi.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	糸 + 又 + 土
English	Thread + Again + Earth

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Via [threading] the [Earth] [again].

♪ Pronunciations

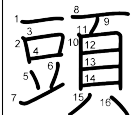
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ケイ (KEI)	へ (he)
L.C.	キョウ (KYŌ)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

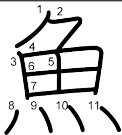
Via <headcount> we <CATERED> in <KYOTO>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
経る	<i>elapse; pass through</i>	へる (heru)
経由	via + cause = <i>via; by way of</i>	ケイ・ユ (KEIYU)
経験	via + test = <i>experience</i>	ケイ・ケン (KEIKEN)

漢字 23: Head (頭)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Head.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	豆 + 頁	
English	Bean/A kind of a Vessel + Big Shell	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Head is [a kind of a vessel] like a [big shell].		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	トウ (TŌ)	あたま (atama)
L.C.	ズ、ト (ZU, TO)	かしら (kashira)
You are most likely to encounter ズ in only a pair of words: 頭上 (ズ・ジョウ/ZUJŌ) “ <i>overhead</i> ”, from the 漢字 ‘head’ and ‘upper’, and the final sample compound of Entry 461.		
♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Head (TOPS) of <atamasco> lillies (TORTURED) by the <cashier> into (ZUCCHINI) strips.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
頭	head	あたま (atama)
先頭	precede + head = <i>at the lead; at the head</i>	セン・トウ (SENTŌ)
店頭	shop + head = <i>storefront; shopwindow</i>	テン・トウ (TENTŌ)

漢字 24: Fish (魚)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Fish.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	魚	
English	Fish	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#195).		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ギョ (GYO)	さかな (sakana)
L.C.	—	うお (uo)
♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Fish <suck on arteries> <you occupy> in (GION).		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
魚	fish	さかな (sakana)
金魚	gold + fish = <i>goldfish</i>	キン・ギョ (KINGYO)
人魚	person + fish = <i>mermaid; merman</i>	ニン・ギョ (NINGYO)

漢字 25: Actual (実)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
This 漢字 has to do with the actual nature or reality of things.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	宀 + 三 + 人
English	Roof + Three + Person

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Actually	, the 「roof」 covered 「three」 「people」.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジツ (JITSU)	—
L.C.	—	み、みの (mi, mino)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Actually	a <minor> <mirror> ⟨JU-JITSU⟩.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
事実	matter + actual = <i>fact</i>	ジ・ジツ (JI-JITSU)
実用	actual + utilize = <i>practical use; utility</i>	ジツ・ヨウ (JITSU-YŌ)
実行	actual + go = <i>put into practice; execute</i>	ジツ・コウ (JIK-KŌ)